

Table 5.1.5 : In-migration, Out-migration, and Net Migration by District, 2024

District	In migration	Out migration	Net migration
Colombo	519,379	384,245	+135,134
Gampaha	524,737	155,712	+369,025
Kalutara	192,833	126,566	+66,267
Kandy	172,489	287,823	-115,334
Matale	82,805	105,145	-22,340
Nuwara Eliya	60,934	169,381	-108,447
Galle	95,154	183,490	-88,336
Matara	95,958	202,894	-106,936
Hambantota	69,567	107,848	-38,281
Jaffna	29,253	76,684	-47,431
Mannar	22,572	26,683	-4,111
Vavuniya	43,046	51,931	-8,885
Mullaitivu	27,573	1,981	+25,592
Kilinochchi	50,544	2,030	+48,514
Batticaloa	20,395	28,134	-7,739
Ampara	76,457	57,987	+18,470
Trincomalee	35,253	42,261	-7,008
Kurunegala	205,372	210,715	-5,343
Puttalam	104,263	88,874	+15,389
Anuradhapura	153,432	119,607	+33,825
Polonnaruwa	96,237	62,382	+33,855
Badulla	74,945	160,850	-85,905
Moneragala	85,183	64,841	+20,342
Ratnapura	95,751	155,436	-59,685
Kegalle	102,066	162,698	-60,632

Duration of Residence and Reason for Migration

Table 5.1.6 presents the duration of residence for in-migrants within their current district of usual residence. The data reveals that 62.9 percent of the total in-migrant population has resided in their current district for 10 years or more, indicating that internal migration in Sri Lanka is predominantly characterized by long-term mobility.

Furthermore, Table 5.1.7 enumerates the primary reasons for migrating to the district of usual residence. When considering the total migrant population, marriage emerges as the leading cause of migration, accounting for 41.8 percent of all movements. This is followed by employment or job-seeking (17.5%) and family-related reasons (16.6%).